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Carol Donnelly



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Re: (No Subject)

...

Viktoria Birger vbirge@vumail.io

6:19 PM



To me

Carol,

You never responded to my old-fashioned phone calls so I thought I'd try an old-fashioned email that stares back at you from your computer or phone until you can do nothing else but respond. If I do not hear back, a postcard will arrive by pony. Is everything okay?

Fondly,
Viktoria

Carol Donnelly olympicarol@vumail.io

5:23 AM

To Viktoria Birger vbirge@vumail.io

Dear Viktoria,

I'm sorry I've been out of touch. There's a lot going on here at the old rink these days. Between shutting down for renovations and all the sacrifices I've made for a huge upcoming deal (which I can't do anything more than hint at for legal reasons), I'm completely beside myself these days.

On top of that, my car just up and died on me a few weeks ago. I've been using a rental for now, and it's not cheap. Hopefully money won't be an issue soon enough, but until that day, I'm certainly feeling quite the culmination of stress.

The one piece of good news that's carrying me through: FUTURES KATE!'s budget for the upcoming year has finally gone through. To say I'm happy with it would be the understatement of a lifetime. I'm going to be able to do some real good with the organization from here on out. Usher in an entire new generation of skaters. Make a real impact on the world before it's too late.

Remember when we were just kids at SAIST, Vik? When Nathan and I won, I thought I'd really made something of myself. Until the next morning, when the press called me vapid and said that he'd carried the both of us through the competition.

I wouldn't admit it to myself until years later, but I think a part of me realized then that I'd only be able to have a real legacy if I created something totally separate from my partnership with Nathan.

The public still loves him so much more than me. He'll never really realize how charmed a life he has, no matter how often I try to make him understand.

Well, that's me venting. How are you, dear? Tell me something inspiring and life-affirming.

Warmly,
C.



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Re: (No Subject)



Viktoria Birger vbirge@vumail.io

1:34 PM



To me

Hello again my American Ferret,

I remember the SAIST as if it were yesterday. Seeing you and Nathan in your shimmering showbiz uniforms, so much fringe and sequin. It was a true performance, not just the skating. Honestly, before the competition I thought you were both just so horrifically tacky that you couldn't possibly be good at the sport... until you took to the ice. Even I had to admit that you both deserved the award after that.

And now, the update: The family is fine. Freya and I split up at long last, the car crash in slow motion finally collided with thankfully no casualties. Long distance just wasn't workable. Jotun and Carla are happy for us both to have the chance to reinvent ourselves again. They are both away at university but we will have Christmas together, of course.

For myself, I am a bit lonely to be honest. I am staying in the old family lodge in the country, close to the rink and my students. I have been maybe drinking a bit, a tiny nip of brandy in the morning to help cheer me up when it doesn't come naturally, and my students like me more when I am less serious.

But anyway, Ms. Successful Nonprofit Owner, if you ever want to take a break from raising the next generation of skaters, you're more than welcome to visit the lodge. I'll be here for the next four months before I head back to Three Pines. I can promise you frozen lakes for skating, homemade gingerbread cookies, and brandy by the fireplace at night.

You're always welcome,

Viktoria